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United States Patent	12408987
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 09, 2025
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Instruments for robotic knee revision

Abstract

A device for registering a bone for a robotic knee arthroplasty with a surgical robot can include a plate and a registration device. The plate can be engageable with the bone and can include a lateral portion, a medial portion, and a hinge. The registration device can be connected to the plate and can be configured to interface with the surgical robot for registration of the plate and the bone.

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Appl. No.: 17/833432

Filed: June 06, 2022

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20220387121 A1	Dec. 08, 2022

Related U.S. Application Data

us-provisional-application US 63197693 20210607

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: A61B34/20 (20160101); A61B17/15 (20060101); A61B34/30 (20160101); A61F2/46 (20060101); A61B34/10 (20160101); A61B90/00 (20160101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **A61B34/20** (20160201); **A61B17/154** (20130101); **A61B34/30** (20160201); **A61F2/461** (20130101); A61B2034/102 (20160201); A61B2034/2055 (20160201); A61B2090/367 (20160201); A61B2090/3983 (20160201); A61F2002/4658 (20130101)

Field of Classification Search

CPC: A61B (17/80); A61B (17/8023); A61B (17/90); A61B (34/20); A61B (2034/2055); A61B (2090/3916); A61B (2090/3983); A61B (17/8061); A61F (2/461); A61F (2002/4632)

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Background/Summary

CLAIM OF PRIORITY (1) This application claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Patent Application Ser. No. 63/197,693, filed on Jun. 7, 2021, the benefit of priority of which is claimed

hereby, and which is incorporated by reference herein in its entirety

BACKGROUND

(1) Implants are commonly used to replace various components of a human body, such as bones, bone joints, or tissues. Joint replacement procedures include shoulder replacement procedures (or shoulder arthroplasties), hip replacement procedures (or hip arthroplasties), or knee replacement procedures (knee arthroplasty). In robotic joint replacement procedures navigational systems are used to help guide a surgeon or to perform operations. During a knee arthroplasty, for example, a registration marker can be secured to a bone.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) In the drawings, which are not necessarily drawn to scale, like numerals may describe similar components in different views. Like numerals having different letter suffixes may represent different instances of similar components. The drawings illustrate generally, by way of example, but not by way of limitation, various embodiments discussed in the present document.
- (2) FIG. 1 illustrates a robotic surgical system including a robotic surgical device (e.g., a robot or a robotic arm) and a computer (e.g., a device having a processor).
- (3) FIG. 2A illustrates a top isometric view of a femur and a portion of a registration device.
- (4) FIG. 2B illustrates a top isometric view of a femur and a portion of a registration device.
- (5) FIG. 2C illustrates a top isometric view of a femur and a portion of a registration device.
- (6) FIG. 3 illustrates a front isometric view of a femur and a portion of a registration device.
- (7) FIG. 4 illustrates top isometric view of a portion of a registration device.
- (8) FIG. 5 illustrates front isometric view of a portion of a registration device.
- (9) FIG. 6 illustrates front isometric view of a femur and a portion of a registration device.
- (10) FIG. 7 illustrates front isometric view of a femur and a portion of a registration device.
- (11) FIG. 8 illustrates front isometric view of a portion of a registration device.
- (12) FIG. 9 illustrates front isometric view of a femur and a portion of a registration device.
- (13) FIG. 10 illustrates front isometric view of a portion of a registration device.
- (14) FIG. 11 illustrates front isometric view of a portion of a registration device.
- (15) FIG. 12 illustrates block diagram of a method of using any of the devices discussed herein.
- (16) FIG. 13 is a block diagram illustrating an example of a machine upon which one or more embodiments may be implemented.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (17) Computer-assisted surgery has been developed in order to help a surgeon to alter bones, and to position or orient implants to a desired location. Computer-assisted surgery may encompass a wide range of devices, including surgical navigation, pre-operative planning, and various robotic devices. Many conventional techniques of joint arthroplasties do not use a robot, which can result in errors or can lack precision. Robotic-assisted surgical systems can help to reduce errors and increase precision. In a robotic-assisted surgery, tracking or navigation devices can be used to help improve determination of a location of bones and instruments by the robotic surgical systems to help improve accuracy of positioning or cutting operations performed, in part or in whole, by the robotic surgical system. However, the tracking devices must be able to accommodate bones of various sizes to ensure proper fixation to the bone. Further, placement of standard pins can interfere with operations performed during a procedure, such as reaming of a tibia of femur.
- (18) This disclosure can help to address these issues by including specialized instruments that allow for standard reference arrays to be secured to bones during a robotic surgical procedure. For example, a bone plate can be securable to a femur using one or more bone screws to help limit penetration distance of the fastener to help avoid interference with reaming operations. The plate

can also include a hinge to allow the plate to be adjusted to accommodate bones of various sizes. The plate can include a registration marker connected thereto so that the optical navigation tracking system can identify and locate the plate to locate the bone within space, allowing the robotic surgical system to accurately track the location of the bones during a robotic-assisted surgical procedure. The plate can also attach to the bones using screws to help limit interference between the fasteners and a reamer or stem of an implant.

(19) The above discussion is intended to provide an overview of subject matter of the present patent application. It is not intended to provide an exclusive or exhaustive explanation of the invention. The description below is included to provide further information about the present patent application.

(20) FIG. 1 illustrates a robotic surgical system **100** including a robotic surgical device **102** (e.g., a robot or a robotic arm) and a computing device **104** (e.g., a device having a processor) in accordance with at least one example of this disclosure. In an example, the robotic surgical device **102** and the computing device **104** may be coupled, such as communicatively coupled or physically connected.

(21) The system **100** can include an optical navigation system **106** that can detect a location of an optical navigation device **110**. The optical navigation device **110** can include imaging reference points **112** recognizable (individually or in a group) by the optical navigation system **106**. The system **100** is shown in relation to a patient **108**. The patient **108** can be undergoing an arthroplasty procedure, for example to replace a knee joint. However, the system **100** can be used for hip or shoulder arthroplasties. The robotic surgical device **102** may be used to perform aspects of the procedure.

(22) In an example, a bone or bones of the patient **108** may be modeled before an existing implant is removed in a revision procedure. The current bone model can be in a virtual 3D format. For example, frontal and lateral images of the bone can be used to generate a current bone model (e.g., via a front and a medial x-ray). In an example, a model of the bone can include a surface geometry of parts of the bone that are exposed. The bone modeling can include generating a 3D surface of the bone when the bone modeling is not directly performed by the imaging equipment, or if not complete. Additional structures can be modeled as well, such as cartilage, hip joint, hip, ankle, etc. A model can be generated using imaging techniques, such as from two x-rays, for example a frontal and a medial x-ray. These two x-rays may be lined up and a model may be generated using a 3D projection or estimation of the patient anatomy. Other imaging techniques may be used, such as CT scanning (computerized tomography), fluoroscopy, or like radiography methods, for example any that provide suitable resolution of images.

(23) In an example, the patient anatomy may be modeled preoperatively, and used to plan steps of the surgical procedure. Deviations from the plan may occur during the procedure, and modifications to the plan (e.g., replanning) may occur intraoperatively, such as when using a robotic surgical device (e.g., as described above with respect to the robotic surgical device **102**). A model can also be generated intraoperatively, for example using registration and optical navigation. This model may not be a fully rendered 2D or 3D model of the patient anatomy, but can instead include key points, interpolated or extrapolated points, or other information used for completing a revision procedure.

(24) The models described with respect to the patient anatomy need not be actually rendered or displayed. Instead, the models can be used by a robotic surgical device to perform portions of a revision procedure. For example, coordinates of registered points and interpolated or extrapolated other points, simulation of coordinates as moved or cut during a procedure, or the like can be stored in memory. A robotic surgical device can retrieve data stored in the memory when performing a portion of the revision procedure.

(25) In terms of planning, an operator may select a position or orientation of a 3D model of a replacement implant that is to be used in the arthroplasty surgery. In another example, the position

or orientation may be automatically generated (e.g., using machine learning). Further planning can include determining a location for a cut plane to support the implant.

(26) In an example, the robotic surgical device **102** can be used to cut the bone, for example using a reference guide developed from the 3D model of the bone and the existing implant. The robotic surgical device can autonomously or collaboratively with the surgeon perform the cut (e.g., using the optical navigation system **106** to guide the robotic surgical device **102**). The optical navigation system **106** can track the optical navigation device **110**, which can be affixed to a bone or an implant of the patient, or affixed to a portion of the robotic surgical device **102**. Several optical navigation devices (e.g., trackers) **110** can be used, for example one on each of a femur, tibia, and the robotic surgical device **102**. From the tracking information gathered by the optical navigation system **106** used to track each of the optical navigation devices, the robotic surgical device **102** can be guided to perform a cutting or reaming operation

(27) FIG. 2A illustrates a top isometric view of a femur **50** and a portion of a registration device **200A**. FIG. 2C illustrates a top isometric view of a femur and a portion of a registration device **200B**. FIG. 2C illustrates a top isometric view of a femur and a portion of a registration device **200C**. FIGS. 2A-2C show how a plate of a registration device can be connected to bones of various sizes. FIGS. 2A-2C also show orientation indicators Anterior, Posterior, Lateral, and Medial. FIGS. 2A-2C are discussed together below.

(28) A femoral implant **52** can be secured to a distal portion of the femur **50** and a portion of the stem **54** (**54A**, **54B**, **54C**) can be located within an intramedullary canal of the femur **50**. The femur **50** and the implant **52** can be various sizes in FIGS. 2A-2C. For example, the femur **50A** and its implant **52A** can be smaller than the femur **50B** and its implant **52B**, which can be smaller than the femur **50C** and its implant **52C**. The registration devices **200A-200C** of FIGS. 2A-2C can be the same device in multiple configurations and can include a plate **201** including a lateral portion **202**, a medial portion, **204**, and a hinge **206**. The device **300** can also include a marker (or a portion of a registration marker) **208** (similar to the device **110** of FIG. 1). The registration devices **200** can also include lateral fasteners **210** and medial fasteners **212**. The registration devices discussed herein can be similar to any of those shown in the patent to Sébastien Jutras, U.S. patent application Ser. No. 11/555,947, entitled “Multifaceted Tracker Device For Computer-Assisted Surgery,” filed on Nov. 2, 2006, which is hereby incorporated by reference herein in its entirety.

(29) Generally, the device **200** and its components can be made of materials such as metals, plastics, foams, elastomers, ceramics, composites, or combinations thereof. In some examples, the device **200** can be comprised of biocompatible materials such as such as stainless steels, cobalt-chromium, titanium variations, polyether ether ketone (PEEK), polyether ketone ketone (PEKK) or combinations thereof.

(30) The lateral portion **202** and the medial portion **204** of the plate **201** can each be a plate or a portion of a plate engageable with a bone such as at a lateral portion of the femur **50** and a medial portion of the femur, respectively. The medial portion **204** of the plate **201** can be connected to the lateral portion **202**. The medial portion **204** can be engageable with a bone such as at a medial portion of the femur **50**. Though the lateral portion **202** and the medial portion **204** are discussed as engaging lateral and medial portions of the femur **50**, the lateral portion **202** and the medial portion **204** can engage any portion of any bone. The lateral portion **202** can be connected to the medial portion **204** by the hinge **206**, which can be a sliding hinge, pivoting hinge, linkage, or the like. The marker **208** can be connected to the plate **201** and can be configured to interface with the surgical robot (e.g., **102**) for registration of the plate and the bone.

(31) In operation of some examples, as shown in FIG. 2A, the lateral portion **202** can be positioned to engage an anterior or lateral portion of the femur **50A**. The medial portion **204** can engage the medial portion of the femur **50A** and the lateral portion **202** and the medial portion **204** can be adjusted or moved with respect to each other to position the lateral portion **202** and the medial portion **204** as desired with respect to the femur **50**. Once the lateral portion **202** and the medial

portion **204** are positioned as desired, the fasteners **210** can be secured through the lateral portion **202** and into the femur **50A** and the fasteners **212** can be secured through the medial portion **204** and into the femur **50A**. The plate **201** can thereby be secured to a small-sized femur, the femur **50A**. The fasteners can be configured (e.g., sized and shaped) such that the fasteners **210** and **212** do not extend to an intramedullary canal of the femur or to the stem **54** of the implant **52**, which can help limit interference between the fasteners **210** and **212** and the stem **54** (or a reamer during a reaming operation).

(32) In operation of the example shown in FIG. 2B, the lateral plate **202** can be adjusted in position relative to the medial plate **204** via the hinge **206** to help allow the medial plate **204** to reach the medial side of the femur **50B** while the lateral plate **202** can reach an anterior or lateral portion of the femur **50B**. The fasteners **210** and **212** can then be used to secure the plate **201** to the femur **50B**. In this way, the plate **201** can be secured to a medium-sized or average-sized femur **50B**. The plate **201** can thereby be secured to a medium-sized femur, the femur **50C**. Optionally, the lateral portion **202** can be contoured (e.g., sized or shaped) to engage a lateral portion of the femur **50** and the medial portion **204** can be contoured (e.g., sized or shaped) to engage a medial portion of the femur **50**.

(33) In operation of the example shown in FIG. 2C, the lateral plate **202** can be adjusted in position relative to the medial plate **204** via the hinge **206** to extend as far away from each other as possible to help allow the medial plate **204** to reach the medial side of the femur **50C** while the lateral plate **202** can reach an anterior or lateral portion of the femur **50C**. The fasteners **210** and **212** can then be used to secure the plate **201** to the femur **50C**. In this way, the plate **201** can be secured to a large-sized femur **50C**. That is, the plate **201** allows for the marker **208** to be fixedly secured to femurs of various sizes with minimal adjustments to the plate **201**.

(34) FIG. 3 illustrates a front isometric view of the femur **50** and a portion of the registration device **200**. FIG. 3 also shows orientation indicators Lateral and Medial. The registration device **200** of FIG. 3 can be similar to the registration device of FIGS. 2A-2C; FIG. 3 shows additional details of the registration device.

(35) For example, FIG. 3 shows that the lateral portion **202** can include one or more fastener bores **214a** and **214b** for receiving the fasteners **210a** and **210b**, respectively, therethrough to secure the lateral portion **202** to the femur **50**. Similarly, the medial portion **204** can include one or more fastener bores **216a** and **216b** for receiving the fasteners **212a** and **212b**, respectively, therethrough to secure the medial portion **204** to the femur **50**.

(36) FIG. 3 also shows that the hinge **206** can be defined, at least in part, by a pair of arms **218a** and **218b** of the lateral portion **202**, where the arms **218** can be relatively elongate members defining a channel or slot **220** therebetween. FIG. 3 further shows that the medial portion **204** can include a block or a slider block **222** connected to the arms **218** and located at least partially in the channel **220**. The slider block **222** can be secured to the lateral portion **202** by pins (shown in FIG. 4) that allow the slider block to translate within the slot **220** to allow relative lateral-medial movement of the lateral portion **202** and the medial portion **204** with respect to each other. The hinge **206** can thereby allow for the lateral portion **202** and the medial portion **204** to be adjusted, as desired, to engage a patient's femur (or other bone).

(37) FIG. 4 illustrates top isometric view of a portion of the registration device **200**. FIG. 4 also shows orientation indicators Lateral and Medial. The registration device **200** of FIG. 4 can be similar to the registration device of FIGS. 2A-3; FIG. 4 shows additional details of the registration device.

(38) For example, FIG. 4 shows a first pin **224b** that can be connected to an outer portion of the slider block **222** and can be positioned in a first guide channel **226b** of the arm **218b**. Similarly, a second pin **224a** can be connected to an outer portion of the slider block **222** (opposite the first pin **224b**) and can be positioned in a second guide channel **226a** of the arm **218a**.

(39) FIG. 4 also shows a third pin **228b** that can be connected to an inner portion of the arm **218b**

and can be positioned in a third guide channel **230b** of the slider block **222**. Similarly, a fourth pin **228a** can be connected to an inner portion of the arm **218a** (opposite the third pin **228b**) and can be positioned in a fourth guide channel **230a** of the slider block **222**.

(40) Each of the guide channels **226** and **230** can include ends or stops engageable with the pins to help limit translation of the pins **224** and **228** and the slider block **222** and therefore the lateral portion **202** with respect to the medial plate **204**. Additionally, by using multiple of the pins **224** and **228**, the pins **224** and **228** can engage edges of the guide channels **226** and **230**, respectively, to help limit rotation of the lateral portion **202** with respect to the medial portion **204**.

(41) FIG. 5 illustrates front isometric view of a portion of a registration device **500**. FIG. 5 also shows orientation indicators Lateral and Medial. The registration device **500** can be similar to the registration device **200** discussed above; the registration device **500** can differ in that the registration device **500** can include a hinge that rotates or pivots. Any of the registration devices discussed above or below can be modified to include such a hinge.

(42) More specifically, the registration device **500** can include a plate **501** and a marker **508**. The plate **501** can include a lateral portion **502**, a medial portion **504**, and a hinge **506**. The lateral portion **502** can be connected to the medial portion **504** by the hinge **506**. The hinge **506** can be defined, at least in part, by knuckle **532** of the lateral portion **502** and knuckles **534** of the medial portion **504**. A pin or fastener can extend through the knuckles to help form the joint **506**.

(43) In operation, the knuckles **534** and **532** can pivot about the pin to allow relative rotation of the knuckles **532** and **534** and therefore relative rotation of the lateral portion **502** and the medial portion **504**. In this way, the lateral portion **502** and the medial portion **504** can be rotated to obtain a desired position or orientation of the lateral portion **502** and the medial portion **504** for securing of the plate **501** to a bone (e.g., a femur or tibia).

(44) FIG. 6 illustrates front isometric view of a femur and a portion of a registration device. FIG. 6 also shows orientation indicators Lateral and Medial. The registration device **600** can be similar to the registration device **500** discussed above; the registration device **600** can differ in that the registration device **600** can include bone spikes. Any of the registration devices discussed above or below can be modified to include bone spikes.

(45) More specifically, the registration device **600** can include a plate **601** and a marker **608**. The plate **601** can include a medial portion **602**, a lateral portion **604**, and a hinge **606**. The medial portion **602** can be connected to the lateral portion **604** by the hinge **606**. The hinge **606** can be defined, at least in part, by knuckle **632** of the medial portion **602** and knuckles **634** of the lateral portion **604**. FIG. 4 also shows a pin **636** or fastener that can extend through the knuckles to help form the joint **606**.

(46) The lateral portion **604** can also include bone spikes or projections **638**. The bone spikes **638** can extend away from an inner surface **640** (e.g., a surface configured or contoured to engage the femur **50**) of the lateral portion **604**. The bone spikes **638** can be configured to penetrate the bone **50** or to increase friction therebetween such as to temporarily secure the lateral portion **604** to the bone **50** before the fasteners are secured to the bone **50**. Though three bone spikes are shown, the lateral portion **604** can include 1, 2, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, or the like bone spikes. The medial portion **602** can also include one or more bone spikes **639**.

(47) FIG. 7 illustrates front isometric view of a femur **50** and a portion of a registration device **700**. FIG. 7 also shows an implant **52** including a stem **54** and orientation indicators Lateral and Medial. The registration device **700** can be similar to the registration devices **200**, **500**, and **600** discussed above; the registration device **700** can differ in that the registration device **700** can include an adjustable translating hinge. Any of the registration devices discussed above or below can be modified to include such a hinge.

(48) More specifically, the registration device **700** can include a plate **701** and a marker **708**. The plate **701** can include a lateral portion **702**, a medial portion **704**, and a hinge **706**. The lateral portion **702** can be connected to the medial portion **704** by the hinge **706**. The hinge **706** can be

defined, at least in part, by a boss **742** of the lateral portion **702** and a boss **744** of the medial portion **704**. The boss **742** can include a bore **746** and the boss **744** can include a channel **748**.

(49) The hinge **706** can also include an actuator, adjustment member, or screw **750**. The adjustment member **750** can be inserted through the bore **746** and can be connected to the channel **748** to form, at least in part, the hinge **706**. The adjustment member **750** can be threadably engaged with the bore **746** and can form a socket joint with the channel, such that the adjustment member **750** can be captured or captivated by the channel **748** but free to rotate with respect thereto. Such an arrangement can allow for rotation of the adjustment member **750** to cause translation of the boss **742** with respect to the boss **744** and therefore translation of the lateral portion **702** with respect to the medial portion **704**, such as before securing the lateral portion **702** or medial portion **704** to the bone **50**. This hinge **706** can thereby allow for fine control of the relative positions of the lateral portion **702** and the medial portion **704**.

(50) FIG. **8** illustrates front isometric view of a portion of a registration device **800**. FIG. **8** also shows orientation indicators Lateral and Medial. The registration device **800** can be similar to the registration device **700** discussed above. Any of the registration devices discussed above or below can be modified to include such a hinge.

(51) The registration device **800** can include a plate **801** and a marker **808**. The plate **801** can include a lateral portion **802**, a medial portion **804**, and a hinge **806**. The lateral portion **802** can be connected to the medial portion **804** by the hinge **806**. The hinge **806** can be defined, at least in part, by a boss or slider block **842** of the lateral portion **802** and a slot or channel **852** of the medial portion **804**. The boss **842** can include a bore **846**. The medial portion **804** can include a second channel **854** and a pin **856**. The hinge can also include an actuator, adjustment member, or screw **850** including a head **858**.

(52) The adjustment member **850** can be threadably secured to the bore **846** of the slider block **842** and the head **858** can form a socket joint with the second slot **854**, such that the adjustment member **850** is captured in the second slot **854** by the pin **856** such that the head is free to rotate in the second slot **854** but is limited in translation with respect to the second channel **854**. The slider block **842** can be located at least in part in the channel **852** of the lateral portion **804**. In operation, the adjustment member **850** can be rotated to cause translation of the medial portion **804** with respect to the lateral portion **802**, such as to obtain a desired position of the lateral portion **802** with respect to the medial portion **804** before securing the lateral portion **804** or medial portion **804** to the bone **50**.

(53) FIG. **9** illustrates front isometric view of a femur **50** and a portion of a registration device **900**. FIG. **9** also shows an implant **52** and orientation indicators Lateral and Medial. The registration device **900** can be similar to the registration devices **200** and **500-800** discussed above; the registration device **900** can differ in that the registration device **900** can include a bone pin. Any of the registration devices discussed above or below can be modified to include such a bone pin.

(54) More specifically, the registration device **900** can include a plate **901** and a marker **908**. The plate **901** can include a lateral portion **902**, a medial portion **904**, and a hinge **906**. The lateral portion **902** can be connected to the medial portion **904** by the hinge **906**. The hinge **906** can be similar to any of the hinges discussed herein. The plate **901** can also include a bone pin or spike **960**. The bone pin **960** can be extendable through a bore **962** of the medial plate **904**. In operation, a surgeon can drive the bone pin **960** through the bore and into the femur **50** to secure the medial portion **904** to the femur **50** before the fasteners of the device **900** are secured to the femur. The pin **960** can include a cap for quick extraction of the pin **960** from the bone.

(55) FIG. **9** also shows that the device **900** can include a boss **964** extending from an outer portion of the medial portion **904** (the boss **964** can be optionally connected to the lateral portion **902**). The boss **964** can define a bore **966** therein that can be configured to receive a distal portion **968** of the registration device **908** therein to secure the registration device **908** to the plate **901**. Any of the previously discussed plates can be modified to include such a boss.

(56) FIG. 10 illustrates front isometric view of a portion of a registration device **1000**. The registration device **1000** can be similar to those registration devices discussed above; the registration device **1000** can differ in that the registration device **1000** can include a clamping mechanism. Any of the registration devices discussed above or below can be modified to include such a clamping mechanism.

(57) The registration device **1000** can include a body **1070** and arms **1072a** and **1072b**. The device **1000** can also include an actuator **1074**, a worm drive **1076**, worm gears **1078a** and **1078b**, and clamps **1080a** and **1080b**. The arms **1072a** and **1072b** can be connected to the clamps **1080a** and **1080b**, respectively. The clamps **1080** can be configured to engage bone, such as to clamp the device **1000** to bone. The actuator **1074** can be an actuator, such as a knob and can be connected to the body **1072** to allow rotation of the actuator **1074**. Similarly, the worm gears **1072a** and **1072b** can be connected to the body **1070** but can be rotatable with respect thereto. The worm drive **1076** can be connected to the body **1070** or can be connected only to the actuator **1074**.

(58) The arms **1072a** and **1072b** can also be connected to the worm gears **1078a** and **1078b** such that movement of the worm gears **1078a** and **1078b** can cause movement of the arms **1072a** and **1072b**, respectively. The worm gears **1078a** and **1078b** can be engaged with a worm drive **1076** that can be connected to the actuator **1074** such that rotation of the actuator **1074** can cause rotation of the worm gears **1078a** and **1078b** and therefore the arms **1072a** and **1072b** and the clamps **1080a** and **1080b**.

(59) In operation of some examples, rotation of the actuator **1074** can rotate the worm drive **1076** to rotate the worm gears **1078a** and **1078b**. Rotation of the worm gears **1078a** and **1078b** can cause rotational movement of the arms **1072a** and **1072b**, respectively, to move the bone clamps **1080a** and **1080b**, such as to clamp onto a bone for temporary securing of a navigational marker to a bone.

(60) FIG. 11 illustrates front isometric view of a portion of a registration device **1100**. The registration device **1100** can be similar to the registration device **1000** discussed above; the registration device **1100** can differ in that the registration device **1100** can include clamping teeth and stabilizing screws. Any of the registration devices discussed above or below can be modified to include such a clamping mechanism.

(61) The registration device **1100** can include a body **1170** and arms **1172a** and **1172b**. The device **1100** can also include an actuator **1174**, a worm drive **1176**, worm gears **1178a** and **1178b**, and stabilizing screws **1182a** and **1182b**.

(62) The stabilizing screws **1182a** and **1182b** can be connected to the body **1170** and can be threadably engaged with bores of the body **1170** such that rotation of the stabilizing screws **1182** can cause translation of the stabilizing screws **1182** with respect to the body **1170**. In operation, the stabilizing screws **1182** can be operated to engage sharp points of the stabilizing screws **1182** with the bone after the arms **1172** are engaged with the bone. Such engagement of the stabilizing screws **1182** with the bone can help to limit rotational movement of the registration device **1100** with respect to the bone. The arms **1172a** and **1172b** can also include teeth **1184** to help increase friction between the arms **1172a** and **1172b** and the bone to help limit movement of the registration device **1100** with respect to the bone.

(63) FIG. 12 illustrates a schematic view of the method **1200**, in accordance with at least one example of this disclosure. The method **1200** can be a method of registering a bone for a robotic knee arthroplasty using a surgical robot. More specific examples of the method **1200** are discussed below. The steps or operations of the method **1200** are illustrated in a particular order for convenience and clarity; many of the discussed operations can be performed in a different sequence or in parallel without materially impacting other operations. The method **1200** as discussed includes operations performed by multiple different actors, devices, and/or systems. It is understood that subsets of the operations discussed in the method **1200** can be attributable to a single actor, device, or system could be considered a separate standalone process or method.

(64) The method **1200** can begin at step **1202** where a bone can be engaged with a lateral (first)

portion of a plate. For example, the lateral portion **202** of the plate **201** can be engaged with the femur **50**. At step **1204**, the lateral portion can be fastened to the bone. For example, the lateral portion **202** of the plate **201** can be fastened to the femur **50** using fasteners **210**.

(65) At step **1206**, a medial portion of the plate can be adjusted using a hinge of the plate. For example, the medial portion **204** of the plate **201** can be adjusted using the hinge **206**. At step **1208**, engaging the bone with the medial portion of the plate. For example, the medial portion **204** of the plate **201** can be engaged with the femur **50**. At step **1210**, the medial portion of the plate can be fastened to the bone. For example, the medial portion **204** of the plate **201** can be fastened to the femur **50**.

(66) At step **1212**, the bone and the plate can be registered using the surgical robot and a registration device secured to the plate. For example, the femur **50** and the registration marker **208** connected to the plate **201** can be registered using the robotic surgical system **100**. Optionally, the bone can be registered optically using imaging reference points of the registration device using an optical navigation system associated with the surgical robot.

(67) In some examples, the registration device can be removed from the plate. For example, the registration marker **208** can be removed from the plate before the plate **201** is secured to the femur and then the marker **208** can be later secured to the plate **201** before registration.

(68) Optionally, the medial portion of the plate can be adjusted using the hinge, where the adjustment can include rotating the medial portion of the plate with respect to the lateral portion of the plate using the hinge. For example, the medial portion **204** of the plate **201** can be adjusted by rotating the medial portion **204** of the plate **201** with respect to the lateral portion **202** of the plate **201** using the hinge **206**.

(69) Optionally, the medial portion of the plate can be adjusted using the hinge, where the adjustment can include translating the medial portion of the plate with respect to the lateral portion of the plate using the hinge. For example, the medial portion **204** of the plate **201** can be adjusted by translating the medial portion **204** of the plate **201** with respect to the lateral portion **202** of the plate **201** using the hinge **206**.

(70) FIG. **13** illustrates a block diagram of an example machine **1300** upon which any one or more of the techniques (e.g., methodologies) discussed herein may perform. Examples, as described herein, may include, or may operate by, logic or a number of components, or mechanisms in the machine **1300**. Circuitry (e.g., processing circuitry) is a collection of circuits implemented in tangible entities of the machine **1300** that include hardware (e.g., simple circuits, gates, logic, etc.). Circuitry membership may be flexible over time. Circuitries include members that may, alone or in combination, perform specified operations when operating. In an example, hardware of the circuitry may be immutably designed to carry out a specific operation (e.g., hardwired). In an example, the hardware of the circuitry may include variably connected physical components (e.g., execution units, transistors, simple circuits, etc.) including a machine readable medium physically modified (e.g., magnetically, electrically, moveable placement of invariant massed particles, etc.) to encode instructions of the specific operation. In connecting the physical components, the underlying electrical properties of a hardware constituent are changed, for example, from an insulator to a conductor or vice versa. The instructions enable embedded hardware (e.g., the execution units or a loading mechanism) to create members of the circuitry in hardware via the variable connections to carry out portions of the specific operation when in operation.

(71) Accordingly, in an example, the machine readable medium elements are part of the circuitry or are communicatively coupled to the other components of the circuitry when the device is operating. In an example, any of the physical components may be used in more than one member of more than one circuitry. For example, under operation, execution units may be used in a first circuit of a first circuitry at one point in time and reused by a second circuit in the first circuitry, or by a third circuit in a second circuitry at a different time. Additional examples of these components with respect to the machine **1300** follow.

(72) In alternative embodiments, the machine **1300** may operate as a standalone device or may be connected (e.g., networked) to other machines. In a networked deployment, the machine **1300** may operate in the capacity of a server machine, a client machine, or both in server-client network environments. In an example, the machine **1300** may act as a peer machine in peer-to-peer (P2P) (or other distributed) network environment. The machine **1300** may be a personal computer (PC), a tablet PC, a set-top box (STB), a personal digital assistant (PDA), a mobile telephone, a web appliance, a network router, switch or bridge, or any machine capable of executing instructions (sequential or otherwise) that specify actions to be taken by that machine. Further, while only a single machine is illustrated, the term “machine” shall also be taken to include any collection of machines that individually or jointly execute a set (or multiple sets) of instructions to perform any one or more of the methodologies discussed herein, such as cloud computing, software as a service (SaaS), other computer cluster configurations.

(73) The machine (e.g., computer system) **1300** may include a hardware processor **1302** (e.g., a central processing unit (CPU), a graphics processing unit (GPU), a hardware processor core, or any combination thereof), a main memory **1304**, a static memory (e.g., memory or storage for firmware, microcode, a basic-input-output (BIOS), unified extensible firmware interface (UEFI), etc.) **1306**, and mass storage **1308** (e.g., hard drive, tape drive, flash storage, or other block devices) some or all of which may communicate with each other via an interlink (e.g., bus) **1330**. The machine **1300** may further include a display unit **1310**, an alphanumeric input device **1312** (e.g., a keyboard), and a user interface (UI) navigation device **1314** (e.g., a mouse). In an example, the display unit **1310**, input device **1312** and UI navigation device **1314** may be a touch screen display. The machine **1300** may additionally include a storage device (e.g., drive unit) **1308**, a signal generation device **1318** (e.g., a speaker), a network interface device **1320**, and one or more sensors **1316**, such as a global positioning system (GPS) sensor, compass, accelerometer, or other sensor. The machine **1300** may include an output controller **1328**, such as a serial (e.g., universal serial bus (USB), parallel, or other wired or wireless (e.g., infrared (IR), near field communication (NFC), etc.) connection to communicate or control one or more peripheral devices (e.g., a printer, card reader, etc.).

(74) Registers of the processor **1302**, the main memory **1304**, the static memory **1306**, or the mass storage **1308** may be, or include, a machine readable medium **1322** on which is stored one or more sets of data structures or instructions **1324** (e.g., software) embodying or utilized by any one or more of the techniques or functions described herein. The instructions **1324** may also reside, completely or at least partially, within any of registers of the processor **1302**, the main memory **1304**, the static memory **1306**, or the mass storage **1308** during execution thereof by the machine **1300**. In an example, one or any combination of the hardware processor **1302**, the main memory **1304**, the static memory **1306**, or the mass storage **1308** may constitute the machine readable media **1322**. While the machine readable medium **1322** is illustrated as a single medium, the term “machine readable medium” may include a single medium or multiple media (e.g., a centralized or distributed database, and/or associated caches and servers) configured to store the one or more instructions **1324**.

(75) The term “machine readable medium” may include any medium that is capable of storing, encoding, or carrying instructions for execution by the machine **1300** and that cause the machine **1300** to perform any one or more of the techniques of the present disclosure, or that is capable of storing, encoding or carrying data structures used by or associated with such instructions. Non-limiting machine readable medium examples may include solid-state memories, optical media, magnetic media, and signals (e.g., radio frequency signals, other photon based signals, sound signals, etc.). In an example, a non-transitory machine readable medium comprises a machine readable medium with a plurality of particles having invariant (e.g., rest) mass, and thus are compositions of matter. Accordingly, non-transitory machine-readable media are machine readable media that do not include transitory propagating signals. Specific examples of non-transitory

machine readable media may include: non-volatile memory, such as semiconductor memory devices (e.g., Electrically Programmable Read-Only Memory (EPROM), Electrically Erasable Programmable Read-Only Memory (EEPROM)) and flash memory devices; magnetic disks, such as internal hard disks and removable disks; magneto-optical disks; and CD-ROM and DVD-ROM disks.

(76) The instructions **1324** may be further transmitted or received over a communications network **1326** using a transmission medium via the network interface device **1320** utilizing any one of a number of transfer protocols (e.g., frame relay, internet protocol (IP), transmission control protocol (TCP), user datagram protocol (UDP), hypertext transfer protocol (HTTP), etc.). Example communication networks may include a local area network (LAN), a wide area network (WAN), a packet data network (e.g., the Internet), mobile telephone networks (e.g., cellular networks), Plain Old Telephone (POTS) networks, and wireless data networks (e.g., Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE) 802.11 family of standards known as Wi-Fi®, IEEE 802.16 family of standards known as WiMax®, IEEE 802.15.4 family of standards, peer-to-peer (P2P) networks, among others. In an example, the network interface device **1320** may include one or more physical jacks (e.g., Ethernet, coaxial, or phone jacks) or one or more antennas to connect to the communications network **1326**. In an example, the network interface device **1320** may include a plurality of antennas to wirelessly communicate using at least one of single-input multiple-output (SIMO), multiple-input multiple-output (MIMO), or multiple-input single-output (MISO) techniques. The term “transmission medium” shall be taken to include any intangible medium that is capable of storing, encoding or carrying instructions for execution by the machine **1300**, and includes digital or analog communications signals or other intangible medium to facilitate communication of such software. A transmission medium is a machine readable medium.

NOTES AND EXAMPLES

(77) The following, non-limiting examples, detail certain aspects of the present subject matter to solve the challenges and provide the benefits discussed herein, among others.

(78) Example 1 is a device for registering a bone for a robotic knee arthroplasty with a surgical robot, the device comprising: a plate engageable with the bone, the plate comprising: a lateral portion engageable with the bone and including a lateral bore extending through the lateral portion, the lateral bore configured to receive a fastener therethrough to secure the lateral portion to the bone; a medial portion connected to the lateral portion, the medial portion engageable with the bone and including a medial bore extending through the medial portion, the medial bore configured to receive a fastener therethrough to secure the lateral portion to the bone; and a hinge connected to the lateral portion and the medial portion to allow relative movement of the lateral portion and the medial portion before the lateral portion and the medial portion are secured to the bone; and a registration device connected to the plate and configured to interface with the surgical robot for registration of the plate and the bone.

(79) In Example 2, the subject matter of Example 1 optionally includes wherein the hinge is a pivoting hinge configured to allow the lateral portion to rotate with respect to the medial portion.

(80) In Example 3, the subject matter of any one or more of Examples 1-2 optionally include wherein the hinge is a sliding hinge configured to allow the lateral portion to translate with respect to the medial portion.

(81) In Example 4, the subject matter of Example 3 optionally includes wherein the sliding hinge includes a pair of pins connected to the lateral portion and the medial portion to engage the lateral portion and the medial portion to limit rotation of the lateral portion with respect to the medial portion.

(82) In Example 5, the subject matter of any one or more of Examples 2-4 optionally include wherein the lateral portion includes a channel and wherein the medial portion includes a slider block located within the channel and translatable within the channel such that the channel guides translation of the slider block.

- (83) In Example 6, the subject matter of Example 5 optionally includes wherein the plate includes: a first pin and a second pin connected to the slider block and at least partially located in a first guide channel and a second guide channel of the lateral portion, respectively; and a third pin and a fourth pin connected to the lateral portion and at least partially located in a third guide channel and a fourth guide channel of the medial portion, respectively.
- (84) In Example 7, the subject matter of any one or more of Examples 4-6 optionally include wherein the sliding hinge includes an adjustment member connected to the lateral portion and the medial portion, the adjustment member operable to move the lateral portion with respect to the medial portion.
- (85) In Example 8, the subject matter of Example 7 optionally includes wherein the adjustment member is connected to the medial portion to form a socket joint and wherein the adjustment member forms a threaded engagement with the lateral portion.
- (86) In Example 9, the subject matter of Example 8 optionally includes wherein the hinge includes a pin detachably connected to the medial portion and engaged with an outer surface of the adjustment member to retain the adjustment member in the socket joint.
- (87) In Example 10, the subject matter of any one or more of Examples 1-9 optionally include wherein the plate include a bone engagement surface configured to engage an external bone surface.
- (88) In Example 11, the subject matter of Example 10 optionally includes wherein the bone engagement surface includes a projection engageable with the external bone surface to increase friction therebetween.
- (89) In Example 12, the subject matter of any one or more of Examples 7-11 optionally include wherein the lateral portion is contoured to engage a lateral portion of a femur and the medial portion is contoured to engage a medial portion of a femur.
- (90) In Example 13, the subject matter of any one or more of Examples 1-12 optionally include wherein the lateral portion or the medial portion includes a boss extending from an outer portion of the lateral portion or the medial portion, the boss defining a bore configured to receive a distal portion of the registration device therein.
- (91) Example 14 is a method of registering a bone for a robotic knee arthroplasty using a surgical robot, the method comprising: engaging a bone with a lateral portion of a plate; fastening the lateral portion to the bone; adjusting a medial portion of the plate using a hinge of the plate; fastening the medial portion to the bone; and registering the bone and the plate using the surgical robot and a registration device secured to the plate.
- (92) In Example 15, the subject matter of Example 14 optionally includes wherein adjusting the medial portion of the plate using the hinge includes rotating the medial portion of the plate with respect to the lateral portion of the plate using the hinge.
- (93) In Example 16, the subject matter of any one or more of Examples 14-15 optionally include wherein adjusting the medial portion of the plate using the hinge includes translating the medial portion of the plate with respect to the lateral portion of the plate using the hinge.
- (94) In Example 17, the subject matter of any one or more of Examples 14-16 optionally include wherein registering the bone includes optically imaging reference points of the registration device using an optical navigation system associated with the surgical robot.
- (95) In Example 18, the subject matter of any one or more of Examples 14-17 optionally include removing the registration device from the plate; and securing the registration device to the plate.
- (96) In Example 19, the subject matter of any one or more of Examples 14-18 optionally include engaging the bone with the medial portion of the plate.
- (97) In Example 20, the subject matter of any one or more of Examples 14-19 optionally include wherein fastening the lateral portion to the bone and fastening the medial portion to the bone include using bone screws.
- (98) In Example 21, the apparatuses or method of any one or any combination of Examples 1-20

can optionally be configured such that all elements or options recited are available to use or select from.

(99) The above detailed description includes references to the accompanying drawings, which form a part of the detailed description. The drawings show, by way of illustration, specific embodiments in which the invention can be practiced. These embodiments are also referred to herein as “examples.” Such examples can include elements in addition to those shown or described.

However, the present inventors also contemplate examples in which only those elements shown or described are provided. Moreover, the present inventors also contemplate examples using any combination or permutation of those elements shown or described (or one or more aspects thereof), either with respect to a particular example (or one or more aspects thereof), or with respect to other examples or one or more aspects thereof shown or described herein.

(100) In the event of inconsistent usages between this document and any documents so incorporated by reference, the usage in this document controls. In this document, the terms “including” and “in which” are used as the plain-English equivalents of the respective terms “comprising” and “wherein.” Also, in the following claims, the terms “including” and “comprising” are open-ended, that is, a system, device, article, composition, formulation, or process that includes elements in addition to those listed after such a term in a claim are still deemed to fall within the scope of that claim.

(101) The above description is intended to be illustrative, and not restrictive. For example, the above-described examples (or one or more aspects thereof) may be used in combination with each other. Other embodiments can be used, such as by one of ordinary skill in the art upon reviewing the above description. The Abstract is provided to comply with 37 C.F.R. § 1.72(b), to allow the reader to quickly ascertain the nature of the technical disclosure. It is submitted with the understanding that it will not be used to interpret or limit the scope or meaning of the claims. Also, in the above Detailed Description, various features may be grouped together to streamline the disclosure. This should not be interpreted as intending that an unclaimed disclosed feature is essential to any claim. Rather, inventive subject matter may lie in less than all features of a particular disclosed embodiment. Thus, the following claims are hereby incorporated into the Detailed Description as examples or embodiments, with each claim standing on its own as a separate embodiment, and it is contemplated that such embodiments can be combined with each other in various combinations or permutations. The scope of the invention should be determined with reference to the appended claims, along with the full scope of equivalents to which such claims are entitled.

Claims

1. A device for registering a bone for a robotic knee arthroplasty with a surgical robot, the device comprising: a plate engageable with the bone, the plate comprising: a lateral portion engageable with the bone and including a lateral bore extending through the lateral portion, the lateral bore configured to receive a fastener therethrough to secure the lateral portion to the bone, the lateral portion contoured to engage a lateral portion of a femur; a medial portion connected to the lateral portion, the medial portion engageable with the bone and including a medial bore extending through the medial portion, the medial bore configured to receive a fastener therethrough to secure the lateral portion to the bone, the medial portion contoured to engage a medial portion of a femur; and a hinge connected to the lateral portion and the medial portion to allow relative movement of the lateral portion and the medial portion before the lateral portion and the medial portion are secured to the bone; and a registration device connected to the plate and configured to interface with the surgical robot for registration of the plate and the bone.

2. The device of claim 1, wherein the hinge is a pivoting hinge configured to allow the lateral portion to rotate with respect to the medial portion.

3. The device of claim 1, wherein the hinge is a sliding hinge configured to allow the lateral portion to translate with respect to the medial portion.
4. The device of claim 3, wherein the sliding hinge includes a pair of pins connected to the lateral portion and the medial portion to engage the lateral portion and the medial portion to limit rotation of the lateral portion with respect to the medial portion.
5. The device of claim 4 wherein the sliding hinge includes an adjustment member connected to the lateral portion and the medial portion, the adjustment member operable to move the lateral portion with respect to the medial portion.
6. The device of claim 5, wherein the adjustment member is connected to the medial portion to form a socket joint and wherein the adjustment member forms a threaded engagement with the lateral portion.
7. The device of claim 6, wherein the hinge includes a pin detachably connected to the medial portion and engaged with an outer surface of the adjustment member to retain the adjustment member in the socket joint.
8. The device of claim 3, wherein the lateral portion includes a channel and wherein the medial portion includes a slider block located within the channel and translatable within the channel such that the channel guides translation of the slider block.
9. The device of claim 8, wherein the plate includes: a first pin and a second pin connected to the slider block and at least partially located in a first guide channel and a second guide channel of the lateral portion, respectively; and a third pin and a fourth pin connected to the lateral portion and at least partially located in a third guide channel and a fourth guide channel of the medial portion, respectively.
10. The device of claim 1, wherein the plate include a bone engagement surface configured to engage an external bone surface.
11. The device of claim 10, wherein the bone engagement surface includes a projection engageable with the external bone surface to increase friction therebetween.
12. The device of claim 1, wherein the lateral portion or the medial portion includes a boss extending from an outer portion of the lateral portion or the medial portion, the boss defining a bore configured to receive a distal portion of the registration device therein.
13. A method of registering a bone for a robotic knee arthroplasty using a surgical robot, the method comprising: engaging a bone with a lateral portion of a plate, the lateral portion contoured to engage a lateral portion of the bone, the lateral portion including a lateral bore extending through the lateral portion; fastening the lateral portion to the bone through the lateral bore; adjusting a medial portion of the plate using a hinge of the plate connected to the lateral portion of the plate and configured to allow relative movement of the lateral portion and the medial portion before the lateral portion and the medial portion are secured to the bone, the medial portion contoured to engage a medial portion of the bone, the medial portion including a medial bore extending therethrough; fastening the medial portion to the bone through the medial bore; and registering the bone and the plate using the surgical robot and a registration device secured to the plate.
14. The method of claim 13, wherein adjusting the medial portion of the plate using the hinge includes rotating the medial portion of the plate with respect to the lateral portion of the plate using the hinge.
15. The method of claim 13, wherein adjusting the medial portion of the plate using the hinge includes translating the medial portion of the plate with respect to the lateral portion of the plate using the hinge.
16. The method of claim 13, wherein registering the bone includes optically imaging reference points of the registration device using an optical navigation system associated with the surgical robot.
17. The method of claim 13, further comprising: removing the registration device from the plate; and securing the registration device to the plate.

18. The method of claim 13, further comprising: engaging the bone with the medial portion of the plate.
